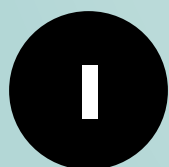




THE NEW-AGE EPFO

**THE EMPLOYEES' PROVIDENT FUND ORGANISATION
IS TAKING STEPS TO MAKE LIFE EASIER FOR ITS
NEARLY 80 MILLION SUBSCRIBERS. CAN THE NEXT
SET OF REFORMS MAKE IT FUTURE-READY?**

BY SURABHI



I **N FEBRUARY** 2024, a 69-year-old pensioner died by suicide in the provident fund (PF) office in Kochi after being unable to withdraw his PF benefits for nine years. Despite multiple visits and submission of papers, it is reported that his dues were not cleared because of 'technical' issues.

The tragic incident brought to the forefront the long delays subscribers and pensioners of the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) often face in not only getting their life's savings but also for minor requests such as correction in personal details.

Over the past few months, the EPFO, the country's second-largest financial institution after